

1.4 Site Preparation Checklist

Everything that has to happen before the first shovel of foundation work — boundaries, utilities, clearing, access, erosion control, and temporary services.

Project Name: _____ Site Address: _____

Owner-Builder: _____ Start Date: _____

Site Supervisor: _____ Completion Date: _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete all site preparation tasks before beginning foundation work. Proper site preparation prevents costly delays and ensures safe, efficient construction. Document completion dates and take photos of critical steps.

CRITICAL — CALL BEFORE YOU DIG

Call 811 (or your local utility locate service) at least 2-3 business days before any digging. Hitting underground utilities can cause serious injury, death, or expensive damage. **IT'S THE LAW.**

PROPERTY BOUNDARY & SURVEY

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Obtain recent property survey (stamped by licensed surveyor)		
☐	Verify all property corners are staked/marked and visible		
☐	Identify all easements (utility, drainage, access rights-of-way)		
☐	Confirm building setback requirements from property lines		
☐	Mark setback lines with temporary stakes or flagging		
☐	Verify no encroachment on neighbors' property or easements		

UTILITY LOCATION (CALL 811)

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Call 811 for underground utility locate — MANDATORY Ticket #: _____ Valid until: _____		
☐	Utilities marked (check each one located): ☐ Electric ☐ Gas ☐ Water ☐ Sewer ☐ Telecom Other: _____		
☐	Take photos of all marked utility locations for records		
☐	Hand-dig within 24" of all marked utilities (no machinery)		
☐	Private utilities (septic, well, propane) marked by owner/contractor		
☐	Contact utility companies if locate marks expired (renew every 30 days)		

TREE PROTECTION & CLEARING

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Identify trees to be saved/protected (per plan or local ordinance)		
☐	Install tree protection fencing at drip line (not at trunk!)		
☐	Post "TREE PROTECTION ZONE — NO EQUIPMENT" signs		
☐	Remove trees/vegetation in building footprint and work zones		
☐	Grind or remove stumps in building area and driveway		
☐	Clear brush and undergrowth from work areas		

TREE PROTECTION & CLEARING

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Stockpile topsoil for later use in landscaping (if applicable)		
☐	Dispose of debris properly (haul away, burn if permitted, chip)		

GRADING & ACCESS

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Perform rough grading to establish building pad elevation		
☐	Establish positive drainage away from building area (2% min slope)		
☐	Create or improve access road/driveway for construction traffic		
☐	Add gravel base to access road if needed (prevent mud/rutting)		
☐	Ensure access road can accommodate concrete trucks, delivery trucks		
☐	Create turnaround area for large vehicles if needed		
☐	Level and compact area for material storage and staging		

EROSION & SEDIMENT CONTROL

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Install silt fence downslope of disturbed areas		
☐	Place erosion control matting on steep slopes (if applicable)		
☐	Install inlet protection for storm drains		
☐	Create temporary diversion swales if needed		
☐	Stabilize disturbed areas not actively being worked (seed/straw)		

EROSION & SEDIMENT CONTROL

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Inspect and maintain erosion controls weekly and after rain events		

TEMPORARY UTILITIES & FACILITIES**Temporary Power**

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Contact electric utility for temporary power service		
☐	Install temporary power pole with meter base and panel (per code)		
☐	Inspection of temporary power: ☐ Required ☐ Not Required Inspection date: _____		
☐	Power connected and active Account #: _____		

Temporary Water

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Temporary water source: ☐ Municipal tap ☐ Well ☐ Water delivery		
☐	Install temporary water line/hydrant at site		
☐	Water available and tested Account #: _____		

Sanitation & Waste

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Portable toilet delivered and positioned Vendor: _____ Service schedule: _____		
☐	Dumpster/waste container delivered and positioned Vendor: _____ Size: _____ Dump schedule: _____		

SITE SECURITY & STORAGE

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Install job box or storage container for tools and materials		
☐	Secure job box with quality locks Lock code/key #: _____		
☐	Post "NO TRESPASSING" and "HARD HAT AREA" signs		
☐	Install temporary fencing if required by jurisdiction or for safety		
☐	Post building permit in visible location (required by law)		
☐	Create secure area for storing expensive materials (windows, etc.)		
☐	Notify neighbors of construction start date and contact info		

FINAL SITE PREPARATION CHECKS

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	Site is level and ready for foundation layout		
☐	Access road is passable in current weather conditions		

FINAL SITE PREPARATION CHECKS

	Task	Date Completed	Notes / Issues
☐	All required permits obtained and posted		
☐	Utilities are located, marked, and documented with photos		
☐	Erosion controls are in place and functional		
☐	Temporary power and water are active and accessible		
☐	Tool storage and sanitation facilities are in place		
☐	Safety equipment available (first aid kit, fire extinguisher)		
☐	Emergency contact numbers posted (911, poison control, inspector)		
☐	Site walkthrough completed with all stakeholders		

SITE PREPARATION SIGN-OFF

I certify that all site preparation tasks have been completed in accordance with approved plans, local codes, and safety requirements. The site is ready for foundation work to commence.

Owner-Builder Signature: _____ Date: _____

Site Supervisor (if different): _____ Date: _____

PHOTO DOCUMENTATION LOG

Take photos of site conditions before, during, and after preparation. Document utility locations, tree protection, erosion controls, and final site readiness.

Date	Photo Description	File Name / Number	Notes

NOTES & ISSUES ENCOUNTERED
